is perceptible by the inner sense (***manas***): when happiness is experienced, this pleasure is a quality belonging to the self and cognition of a quality implies cognition of that to which it belongs.) According to the ***Purva Mimamsakas***, souls are eternal, conscious essences present everywhere. Their involvement in particular circumstances and embodiment is due to ***karma***. Permanent background consciousness is constant amidst the variable psychological states brought about by interaction with the environment. Soul is known in the continuous experience of subjectivity.

According to the ***Samkhya*** school, the souls are inactive centres of consciousness, solitary witnesses uninvolved in worldly life. The view that the soul is not essentially an agent (agency being a function of embodiment) is characteristic of mainstream orthodox Brahminical traditions. But all ***Tantrics*** hold that agency is intrinsic to the soul's nature.

The ***Carvaka*** materialists say that soul is just the body from which consciousness emerges as a by-product of physical processes.

All forms of Buddhism deny the existence of an enduring soul, reducing personal identity to the interplay of five impermanent constituents of personality (***skandhas***): matter, sensations, sense perceptions, behavioural habits and thoughts. These components never amount to an enduring, substantial self or soul. There is no 'inner controller' that is the constant witness of experiences or the persisting principle to which they are all related.

Further reading: Chakrabarti 1999; Lipner 1986; Mookerjee 1975; Neevel 1977

Atma-guna: according to ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika***, these are qualities specific to embodied souls. They are: cognitions (***jnana***), pleasures (*sukha*), pains (***duhkha***), desires